enormous population represented by the BRICS group does not remain a mere bridge between the North and South or a ‘Mediator’ role.

Russia accepted its new strategy for participation in BRICS on February 9, 2013. The process was named ‘Concept of the Russian Federation's Participation in BRICS,’ which clearly stated that Russia wanted to make the bloc a comprehensive institution for daily cooperation on critical global issues. The document said it intends to restructure international financial institutions like the IMF and World Bank (the main focus is redistributing the quotas and votes) (Yuri 2013). While releasing this Concept, the Russian Deputy Prime Minister Sergey Ryabkov said that BRICS is one of Moscow's foreign policy priorities. There are two main reasons behind the Concept: firstly, the group's growing clout in international relations, and secondly, Russia and other group members’ shared strategic interests (Yuri 2013). The ‘Concept of the Russian Federation's Participation in the BRICS’ lists out Russia's primary objectives regarding BRICS, it says, including the transformation of BRICS from a forum of dialogue into a comprehensive mechanism of strategic and day-to-day cooperation on critical global economic and political issues. As far as Russia is concerned, BRICS is not a military bloc; however, it can strengthen international security (Yuri 2013).

The Concept explained that Russia's relations with BRICS based on the UN Charter and generally accepted principles and norms of international law, as well as principles agreed upon by the group members, such as openness, solidarity, pragmatism, non-bloc character, and a non-aggressive nature concerning third parties (Concept of Participation of Russian Federation in the BRICS 2013).[32] Scholars like Nikolai Kodorov (2017) of St. Petersburg State University underscored that BRICS is an additional stage for dialogue and promoting Russia's interests. Russia was the founding and linchpin in making this forum an influential group in present-day world politics, without which its structure would operate only within the political space of South-South countries. The 2013 Participation concept of the Russian Federation in the BRICS group is illustrated below. Being a member of BRICS and availing its Russian foreign policy has a long-term strategy. It is because, as a member, Russia seeks to achieve the following strategic objectives.